

Time Off Business Process

Configuring leave, establishing balances, submitting requests, and recording decisions

Audience: Employees, managers, HR administrators, and process owners

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Document scope

This guide describes the approved HR Agent Sidecar data model and required business process. It distinguishes current Dataverse schema from planned application, automation, and Copilot features.

All names, dates, amounts, and identifiers in examples are fictional and intended for training.

How to use this guide

Use this guide for the complete Time Off lifecycle across Time Off Type, Time Off Balance, and Time Off Request.

Item	Guidance
Intended audience	Employees, managers, HR administrators, and process owners
System of record	Microsoft Dataverse in the HR Agent Sidecar solution
Naming convention	Business names are shown first; Dataverse logical names appear in parentheses.
Required means	The value must be present before the record can be considered process-ready. Dataverse business-required fields are also enforced by the platform or application.
Status discipline	Use the documented Status Reason transitions. Do not simulate process state with notes, record names, or ad hoc fields.

Privacy and least privilege

HR records can contain personal and financial information. Only enter data needed for the approved process. Do not place medical details, payment-card data, credentials, or unrelated sensitive information in free-text fields.

Business outcome

Employees request leave against an understandable annual balance; Managers make traceable decisions; HR can reconcile allocated, pending, and used hours.

Record responsibilities

Entity	Created/maintained by	When
Time Off Type	HR administrator	When a governed leave category is introduced or changed.
Time Off Balance	HR administrator or approved automation	At annual setup, onboarding, or adjustment.
Time Off Request	Employee or authorized HR proxy	Whenever leave is requested.

Process A: configure a Time Off Type

1. Search by Code and Name to prevent duplicates.
2. Enter the approved Name and stable Code.
3. Enter Default Annual Hours when the category has a standard allowance.
4. Set Requires Approval. Use Yes for manager-reviewed leave; use No only for categories authorized for automatic handling.
5. Activate the Type only when it is ready for balances and requests.

Example: Vacation type

Field	Example value
Name	Vacation
Code	VAC
Default Annual Hours	120.00
Requires Approval	Yes
Status	Active

Process B: establish an annual balance

1. Search for an existing balance for the same Employee, Time Off Type, and Calendar Year.
2. If none exists, create one and select the Employee and Time Off Type.
3. Enter Calendar Year and Allocated Hours according to policy and prorating rules.
4. Initialize Pending Hours and Used Hours to zero unless an approved migration or adjustment applies.
5. Name the record consistently, for example “Avery Chen — Vacation — 2026”.
6. Validate available hours: Allocated – Pending – Used.

Example: annual balance

Field	Example value
Name	Avery Chen — Vacation — 2026
Employee	Avery Chen
Time Off Type	Vacation
Calendar Year	2026

Field	Example value
Allocated Hours	120.00
Pending Hours	0.00
Used Hours	0.00
Available Hours	120.00 (derived operationally)
Uniqueness control The approved model expects one balance per Employee + Time Off Type + Calendar Year. Until a Dataverse alternate key is implemented, search before create and treat duplicates as a data-quality incident.	

Process C: create and submit a request

1. Confirm the Employee, Time Off Type, dates, and requested hours.
2. Verify the appropriate annual balance and available hours.
3. Create the request in Draft. Enter Start Date, End Date, Requested Hours, and an optional concise Reason.
4. If approval is required, set Approver to the Employee's current Manager.
5. Before submission, validate Start Date $\leq$ End Date, hours are positive, and dates/hours follow work-calendar policy.
6. Set Submitted On and change Status Reason to Submitted.
7. Increase Pending Hours through the approved automation/manual control. Do not increase Used Hours yet.

Example: request submission

Field	Example value
Name	Avery Chen — Vacation — Aug 10–12
Employee	Avery Chen
Time Off Type	Vacation
Start Date	August 10, 2026
End Date	August 12, 2026
Requested Hours	24.00
Reason	Planned personal leave

Field	Example value
Approver	Morgan Lee
Submitted On	July 24, 2026 10:15 AM
Status Reason	Submitted

Process D: manager decision

7. Open the Submitted request and confirm Employee, Type, dates, hours, overlap, and balance.
8. Do not modify the Employee's request to make it approvable. Reject with a clear reason when correction is needed.
9. For approval, set Decided On, optionally add a Decision Comment, and change Status Reason to Approved.
10. Move the request hours from Pending to Used in the balance.
11. For rejection, set Decided On and Decision Comment, then change Status Reason to Rejected. Remove the hours from Pending.
12. Notify the Employee through the approved workflow/channel.

Status Reason	Meaning	Permitted next status
Draft	Request is editable and not routed.	Submitted or Cancelled
Submitted	Awaiting Manager decision; pending balance applies.	Approved, Rejected, or Cancelled
Approved	Leave is authorized; used balance applies.	Terminal; cancellation requires governed handling
Rejected	Leave is not authorized; pending hours released.	Terminal; create a corrected new request
Cancelled	Request was withdrawn or voided.	Terminal

Balance reconciliation example

Event	Allocated	Pending	Used	Available
Before submission	120	0	16	104
After 24-hour request submitted	120	24	16	80

Event	Allocated	Pending	Used	Available
After request approved	120	0	40	80
If instead rejected	120	0	16	104

Exceptions

Scenario	Correct handling
Insufficient balance	Do not approve unless policy permits a documented exception. Record the decision; do not falsify balance values.
Cross-year request	Apply the organization's split rule; typically create separate requests/balance impacts by calendar year.
Manager unavailable	Use the approved delegation/reassignment procedure and retain the effective Approver.
No-approval Time Off Type	Document the approved automatic process; still record submission and balance movement consistently.
Approved request cancelled	Use a governed reversal that restores Used Hours and records who authorized the cancellation.